

1, Human Societies Across Distinct Regions and Ethnicities Are Governed by Unified Scientific Laws

Behind pluralism emerges a unified scientific law; this scientific law is most intuitively manifested in the **historical sequence** (历史序列)—namely, the six historical stages that human societies sequentially enter.

Every society, predicated upon a specific **social being** (社会存在), manifests the characteristics of disparate historical stages; the evolutionary process of these characteristics over time strictly conforms to the chronological order demarcated by the historical sequence. Under exceptional circumstances, the development of certain societies will deviate from the historical sequence, yet they are fundamentally incapable of achieving transcendence over it; the consequence can only be catastrophic.

I maintain that what people must constantly etch into their memory is that there are absolutely no insurmountable distinctions between distinct ethnicities and regions. We are all *Homo sapiens*; no matter how immense the differences might be, exactly how massive could they possibly be? Indeed, disparate regions have evolved unique cultures over their protracted development. However, regarding what we currently term "cultural differences," how many of them are, in essence, fundamentally not cultural differences at all, but rather "time lags" (时差) in the historical process? This is such a phenomenally ludicrous state of affairs!

In China, in Japan, in Europe, and in the United States, people everywhere are peddling these absurd perspectives, utterly disregarding the mutations in historical stages to play the game of "dynastic power-scaling debates" (朝代斗兽); they erroneously attribute the consequences of societal development directly to the individual traits of rulers. I believe anyone possessing even a rudimentary understanding of historical discussion forums cannot possibly ignore this. Even within the books I read, domestic and foreign scholars committing such blunders abound in numbers as staggering as migrating carp crossing a river, from which one can deduce exactly how ubiquitous such phenomena truly are!

Consider this, everyone! How many people believe that a monarch in a **classical society** (古典社会) expelling foreign barbarians and expanding territories is the reward for their brilliant and martial prowess, whereas a monarch losing territory during **Late Antiquity** (古典时代晚期) is inherently a manifestation of sheer incompetence? We naturally concede that the capabilities of certain monarchs are indeed superior to others, but does an empire in a classical society possess any comparability whatsoever with a tottering empire in Late Antiquity? During the zenith of a **classical empire**, a mediocre ruler in the overwhelming majority of cases inflicts fundamentally no structural damage; yet during Late Antiquity, even generations of enlightened monarchs would find it astronomically difficult to salvage the empire's collapsing predicament.

How many people perceive the victory or defeat between two nations strictly as a duel of their monarchs' capabilities? Khosrow I (库思老一世) and Khosrow II (库思老二世) radiated spectacular brilliance in their wars against Byzantium; was this genuinely the merit of brilliant sovereigns and sagacious ministers? Is it not entirely possible that Byzantine Empire was already deeply troubled by **feudalization** (封建化), whereas Persia had merely just entered a **classical society**? The ability of Kanishka I (迦腻色迦一世) of the Kushan Empire (贵霜帝国) to cross the Pamir Mountains (帕米尔高原) and extend his rule to the southern foothills of the Tianshan Mountains (天山南麓)—was this

because the emperor was invincible, or because the Kushans vastly surpassed the Han Dynasty? Is it not entirely possible that the classical empire of the Kushans was precisely at its zenith, while the Eastern Han (东汉) was already universally littered with feudal manors (封建庄园)?

How many people mistake the ephemeral social phenomena of a nation for its indigenous culture? The Goryeo (高丽) regime could stand its ground without disadvantage against the Liao and Jin empires, yet the Joseon (朝鲜) kingdom was beaten into discarding their helmets and armor by Toyotomi Hideyoshi (丰臣秀吉). So, are the Korean people ultimately martial or un-martial? The Han Dynasty Chinese could mobilize million-strong armies to confront the Xiongnu (匈奴), while the Song Dynasty Chinese merely hoped that peace purchased with wealth was more economically viable. So, are the Chinese ultimately fond of aggression or not?

The factual reality is that these questions are fundamentally not even worth answering. As historical stages mutate, the society itself has already fundamentally changed; how could the orientational predilections of **social consciousness** (社会意识) possibly remain identical? I am not mocking Westerners, but it is phenomenally difficult to imagine that these are the precise individuals who actually nearly conquered the entire world. Wherever Europeans arrived, they unilaterally perceived the characteristics of the local society they witnessed at that exact moment as the inherent characteristics of the local culture. It would be one thing if they believed this during the Age of Discovery, but exactly how many Westerners still believe this today?

How many people interpret the consequences of social movements as "civilization" or the intrinsic traits of a civilization? What is essentially ethnic minorities opting for bureaucratization (官僚化)—thereby inevitably forfeiting their own ethnic characteristics—is consequently interpreted by official Chinese narratives as the formidable assimilation capacity of Han culture (汉文化). This joke was originally intended to deceive their own domestic populace, yet exactly how many foreigners bit onto this straight hook exactly like naive fish? What is most farcical, leaving one utterly speechless and at a loss for words, is that there appears to genuinely be a cohort of Western and Japanese scholars who actually believe this fiction; exactly what are they thinking.

Merely observing these assertions within academia or the internet indeed makes it difficult to viscerally perceive exactly how absurd they are, so I shall employ a joke to illustrate the sheer absurdity of human affairs.

An individual saw a group of children in a kindergarten and discovered that many of them were still wetting their beds, so he declared that this ethnicity called "Child" possesses a prevalent "bed-wetting culture" (尿床文化). Another individual saw a group of seniors in a nursing facility and discovered that many of them suffered from Alzheimer's disease (阿尔兹海默病), so he declared that this ethnicity called "Elderly" possesses a prevalent "dementia culture" (痴呆文化).

In reality, if such "brilliant minds" genuinely existed in the real world, absolutely everyone without exception would treat them as imbeciles. This imbecile witnessing children wetting their beds is solely because the children have not yet grown up; his astonishment at the seniors' cognitive impairment is solely because he himself has not yet grown old. Different stages of life naturally possess different characteristics; this is not a disparity between different individuals, but a disparity between different ages.

However, we need only cast a casual glance at the discussions regarding human history to discover exactly how ubiquitous such imbecilic behavior truly is. This is a profoundly lamentable tragedy for humanity's monumental enterprise of comprehending itself.

Therefore, I sincerely appeal—although it is highly probable that scarcely anyone will listen—that when delineating history, we ought to adopt the nomenclature of "the **historical sequences** (历史序列) of respective localities" as much as possible, entirely discarding the Eurocentric (西方中心论) chronological periodization.

For instance, when the current academic community discusses the history of the Arab Empire (阿拉伯帝国) in the 8th century AD, they are phenomenally fond of utilizing phrasing such as "the Islamic regime of the Early Middle Ages." This invisibly misleads readers, and even the researchers themselves. Indeed, the 8th century AD was already the Middle Ages for Europe, but within the Middle East—particularly within the territories of the former Persian Empire—**classical society** (古典社会) continued to exist, the classical bureaucratic system (古典官僚体制) remained operative, and **feudal society** (封建社会) had fundamentally not yet emerged. How does this qualify as the Middle Ages in any sense? Consequently, one ought to state without the slightest hesitation that the Arab Empire of the 8th century was a classical Islamic empire or a classical empire of the Middle East.

When observing even more backward regions, Westerners manifest an even profounder arrogance. Africa from the 6th to the 15th centuries is also termed "medieval Africa"; yet exactly how many regions in Africa genuinely witnessed the emergence of a **feudal society**? No one cares about this whatsoever. Regarding issues concerning China, Occidentals and Orientals are generally equally muddled. Europeans categorize both the Tang (唐) and Song (宋) empires as "medieval China." This can perhaps be dismissed; after all, it is understandable for the West to exhibit a certain degree of arrogance given its advantageous position. But why do some Japanese scholars genuinely believe the Song Dynasty constituted an **early modern society** (近世社会)? This is simply unfathomable, no matter how hard one racks one's brain.

When discussing the history of disparate regions, particularly history prior to 1500 AD, they should be named strictly according to their own specific developmental stages, rather than adopting a unilateral European standard. This is because the historical processes of different regions globally possess colossal disparities in their velocity. Take Japan during the late Heian period (平安时代晚期) under the Insei system (院政 / cloistered rule), for instance. Even though contemporary Europe had already entered the **High Middle Ages** (中世纪盛期), we ought nevertheless to classify this period strictly as classical Japan. Similarly, the concurrent Khmer Empire (高棉帝国) was fundamentally not a "medieval Southeast Asian regime," but a classical Southeast Asian regime.

If a nation explicitly did not experience a certain historical stage, then that historical stage ought simply not to exist in its nomenclature, rather than forcibly appending it regardless of reality. If the precise societal nature of a specific regime or a specific region during a specific period is genuinely difficult to definitively stipulate, then one should unequivocally employ the European standard strictly to demarcate the chronological timeframe. This is not to imply that Westerners ought to enjoy cultural hegemony, but rather that they are undeniably advanced. After all, Western civilization has traversed the entirety of the **historical sequence** up to the present day; therefore, its timetable possesses maximum referential utility.

In summary, the assertion that the "Middle Ages" equates to 476–1453 AD or 500–1500 AD ought to be utilized with strict limitations. Western Europe being in the Middle Ages fundamentally does not equate to other global regions concurrently being in the Middle Ages; the same applies to all other historical stages. As long as we possess the capacity to execute explicit differentiations, we ought to do exactly that. This brings exclusively benefits and zero detriments to Westerners; their capacity to execute granular categorizations is immensely advantageous for comprehending other global regions. Furthermore, adopting the description of "the historical stages of respective ethnicities" does absolutely zero damage to the West's image; does this not even more transparently manifest their absolute advancement? I am completely incapable of comprehending why Western scholars refuse to do this.

As a Chinese individual, I find it exceedingly difficult to articulate exactly how I feel regarding the concepts held by Westerners. But I maintain they overemphasize their own exceptionalism. There are genuinely multitudinous individuals who believe that **feudalism** (封建主义) existed exclusively in Europe and Japan, and that **feudalism** is inherently not a universal phenomenon. From the perspective of a resident of a non-Western nation like myself, Westerners are fundamentally clueless regarding precisely how they marched toward modernity. They would rather believe in entirely unprovable factors such as God, luck, destiny, or racial superiority, or otherwise attribute it to scripts, languages, and religions—factors which are themselves inherently determined by **social being** (社会存在).

The Japanese identically appear highly insecure from my perspective. Although Japan explicitly parted ways with China on the historical trajectory around 1200 AD, the Japanese (*at least as it appears to me*) still frequently stare at China, doubting where they themselves might have gone wrong. They act as if they fundamentally dare not believe a definitive historical reality: namely, that their ancestors were indeed individuals of supreme intellect and monumental courage, who harnessed their subjective initiative in accordance with the shifting tides of the era to revolutionize **social being**, thereby carving out the pathway leading to universal peace and prosperity.

It is not that various global regions are running on different tracks; rather, they are all exclusively on a singular track, but Western Europe and Japan utterly and unequivocally, without a shred of suspense, won the race. What exactly is there to conceal or feel ashamed about regarding this? Viewed from any conceivable angle, this constitutes a legendary epic, sufficient to be extolled by descendants for another millennium. Even as an outsider, I cannot help but profoundly admire the martial achievements of the feudal **samurai** (武士); a locale like Kamakura (镰仓) is entirely worthy of being designated the heart of the Asian revolution. If the opportunity arises, I identically wish to visit the Tsurugaoka Hachimangū (鹤冈八幡宫) to witness it for myself.

Only by recognizing that the historical development of distinct regions and diverse ethnicities is, in the final analysis, governed by the exact same scientific laws, can humanity possibly eradicate racism from its fundamental roots. The astronomical disparities in the current developmental levels of distinct ethnic groups are, ultimately, determined by the disparities in social evolution dictated by their historical **social being** and underlying developmental laws; it is fundamentally not a question of which ethnicity is superior or inferior. Whether dealing with universally acknowledged "superior ethnicities" or universally despised ones, they are identically entirely encompassed within the objective laws of the social sciences. What determines their destiny is not "racial differences" such as intellect or physical stamina, but the mutation of the historical processes they have undergone.

Under these circumstances, racism naturally loses the very soil upon which it grows. I sincerely hope that one day, when the peoples of various global regions gaze upon one another with curious eyes, they will be capable of realizing that the disparities between them do not stem from race or the absurd notion of "cultural genes" (文化基因), but because the societal morphologies they have experienced, and currently inhabit, are fundamentally different. From the perspective of historical development, the nations of Europe and America, alongside Japan, indeed constitute the paradigms for all of humanity.

1, 不同地区, 不同民族的人类社会受统一的科学规律支配

多元化的背后浮现出的是一种统一的科学规律, 这种科学规律最直观地表现在历史序列上, 即人类社会依次进入的六个历史阶段。每一个社会基于一定的社会存在表现出不同历史阶段的特征, 这些特征随时间的演化过程符合历史序列所标定的顺序。在特殊的情况下, 一些社会的发展会偏离历史序列, 但是无法实现对历史序列的超越, 后果只能是灾难。我认为人们需要时刻谨记的是, 不同民族和地区之间没有什么不可逾越的区别, 大家都是现代智人, 差别再大又能大到哪去呢? 的确, 不同地区在漫长的发展中演变出了独特的文化。但是我们现在所说的“文化差异”, 有多少在本质上根本就不是文化差异而是历史进程上的时差呢? 这一点是多么可笑的事情! 在中国, 在日本, 在欧洲, 在美国, 人们到处在谈论着这些荒谬的观点, 完全忽视历史阶段的变化去玩“朝代斗兽”的游戏, 把社会发展的结果安在统治者个人头上, 我相信任何对于历史讨论区有所了解的人都不可能忽视这一点。甚至在我读的书里面, 中外学者犯这样错误得如过江之鲫, 由此则知这样的事情有多么普遍了!

想一想吧, 各位! 有多少人认为古典社会的君主驱逐外夷, 开疆拓土是英明神武的回报, 古典时代晚期的君主丧土失地就是无能的表现? 我们当然承认一些君主的能力确实比另一些要强, 但是古典社会的帝国能跟古典时代晚期摇摇欲坠的帝国有任何可比性吗? 在古典帝国的鼎盛期, 统治者庸碌一点在绝大多数情况下都造不成损害: 在古典时代晚期, 即使是代代明君帝国也难以挽回局面。

有多少人把两个国家的胜负视为君主能力的对决? 库思老一世和库思老二世在与拜占庭的战争中大放异彩, 真的是主明臣贤的功劳吗? 有没有可能是拜占庭已经封建化, 而波斯才刚刚进入古典社会呢? 贵霜帝国的迦腻色迦一世能够越过帕米尔高原把统治延伸到天山南麓, 是这位皇帝不可一世还是贵霜人远胜汉朝? 有没有可能是因为贵霜的古典帝国正处于鼎盛而东汉已经封建庄园遍地了呢?

有多少人把一个国家一时的社会现象当作当地的文化? 高丽政权面对辽金帝国能够不落下风, 朝鲜王国被丰臣秀吉打到丢盔卸甲, 那么朝鲜人到底尚武还是尚文? 汉朝人能倾上百万军队与匈奴对抗, 宋朝人只希望花钱买来的和平是更加经济的, 那么中国人到底爱不爱好侵略? 事实就是这些问题根本不值得回答, 随着历史阶段的变化社会已经不一样了, 社会意识的偏向性能一样吗? 我不是嘲笑西方人, 但是很难想象就是这些人居然几近征服了世界。欧洲人到达哪里, 就把他们现在看到的当地社会的特征视为当地文化的特征, 要说这在地理大发现的时候这么认为也就罢了, 可是有多少西方人现在还这么相信?

有多少人把社会运动的结果解释成为文明化或者文明的特质? 明明本质上是少数民族选择官僚化从而必然丧失本民族特征, 结果被中国官方解释成为汉文化同化能力强大。这种笑话原本就是骗本国人的, 结果多少外国人一个个像天真的鱼一样咬上了直钩? 最为让人啼笑皆非根本不知道该说什么好的是, 似乎真有一批西方和日本的学者相信这件事, 他们究竟在想什么呢。

只看学术界或者互联网上的这些论断的确没法直观地感受到它们有多荒谬, 所以我用一个笑话来表现世事的荒唐。一个人见到了一群幼儿园里的孩子发现他们很多还在尿床, 于是说这个叫“儿童”的民族盛行着一种尿床文化; 一个人见到了一群养老机构里的老人发现他们很多人患有阿尔兹海默病, 于是说这个叫“老人”的民族盛行着一种痴呆文化。实际上, 如果现实中真的存在这样的妙人, 那么肯定不会有任何人不把他当傻瓜。这个傻瓜看到孩子们尿床, 只是因为儿童还没有长大; 惊讶于老人的神志不清楚, 也只是他自己还没有变老。人生不同阶段当然具有不同的特征, 这不是人和人之间的差异, 而是不同年龄之间的差异。然而只要我们随便看一眼对于人类历史的讨论就会发现这样的傻瓜行为究竟有多常见, 这对于人类认识自身的事业是一件非常可悲的事情。

因此我真诚地呼吁, 虽然大概也很难有人听到, 在描述历史时尽可能采取“各地方的历史序列”这样的称呼, 完全去掉西方中心论的时代划分。就比如现在学界在讨论公元8世纪的阿拉伯帝国史, 还非

常喜欢采用“中世纪早期的伊斯兰政权”这样的说法，它会在无形间误导读者甚至是研究者自身。的确，公元8世纪对于欧洲来说已经是中世纪了，但是在中东特别是原波斯帝国境内古典社会仍然存在，古典的官僚体制仍在运作，封建社会还未出现，这算什么中世纪呢？那就应当毫不犹豫地说八世纪的阿拉伯帝国是一个古典伊斯兰帝国或者中东的古典帝国。在看到更加落后地区的时候，西方人表现得更为傲慢，6到15世纪的非洲也被称为中世纪非洲，可是非洲到底有几处地区出现了封建社会，这又没人在乎了。在有关中国的问题上西洋人和东洋人一般糊涂，欧洲人把唐帝国和宋帝国都认为是中世纪中国，这也就罢了，毕竟西方因其优势地位傲慢一点也是可以理解。但是为什么有些日本人会认为宋代是近世社会？这简直让人想破脑袋都想不通。

在讨论各个地区的历史时，特别是1500年之前的历史时，就应该依其自身的发展阶段来进行命名而不是采取一个欧洲标准，因为世界不同地区的历史进程在快慢上差异很大。就好比平安时代晚期实行院政的日本，就算现在欧洲都已经是中世纪盛期了，那我们也应该把这个时期划入古典日本。同样同时期的高棉帝国也不是什么中世纪东南亚政权，而是一个古典东南亚政权。如果一个国家明确地没有经历过某个历史阶段，那在命名的时候就应该没有这个历史阶段，而不是非要加上不可。如果某个政权或某地某个时期社会的性质难以进行准确规定，这个时候就应该毫不犹豫地使用欧洲的标准以标明时间。这不是说西方人就应该享有文化霸权，而是他们确实先进，毕竟西方文明经历过迄今为止全部的历史序列，因此其时间表具有最大的参考性。总而言之，中世纪等于476年到1453年或者500年到1500年这种说法应当有限度地使用，西欧在中世纪不等于其他地方也同时处于中世纪，其他历史阶段同样。只要我们有能力进行明确区分就应该进行明确区分，这对于西方人只有好处没有坏处，他们能够进行细致的区分对于认识世界其他地区是很有利的。而且采用“各民族的历史阶段”这种描述又不会有损西方的形象，这不是更一目了然地体现出其先进性了吗？我完全不明白为什么西方学者不这样做。

我作为中国人很难描述我对于西方人的观念有什么感受。但我认为他们太过强调自己的特殊性，真的有很多人相信只有欧洲和日本才有封建主义，封建主义不是一种普遍的现象。在我这样的非西方国家的居民看来，西方人根本不知道自己是怎么走向现代的，他们宁可相信上帝，运气，天命或者是种族优势这些根本无法论证的因素，要么就是归因于文字，语言，宗教这些本身就是由社会存在所决定的因素。日本人在我看起来也非常不自信，明明在公元1200年前后日本就与中国在历史进程上分道扬镳了，但日本人（至少在我看来）还常常盯中国怀疑他们自己哪里做得不对。

他们仿佛就是不敢相信一个历史事实，那就是他们的祖先确实是有大智大勇的人，顺应时势发挥自己的主观能动性变革了社会存在，开辟了通向天下太平的道路。不是全世界各个地区在不同的赛道上，而是它们都在一个赛道上，但是西欧和日本彻彻底底地，毫无悬念地赢下了比赛。这有什么好讳言的呢？在任何角度上看都是一部传奇史诗，足以让后人再传诵上千年。我即使作为一个外人都不得不非常仰慕封建武士们的武功，像镰仓这样的地方足以称得上是亚洲革命的心脏，如果有机会的话我也想去鹤冈八幡宫瞧瞧。

只有认识到不同地区，不同民族的历史发展归根到底受到同一种科学规律的支配，人类才可能从根本上消除种族主义。不同族群现如今的发展水平千差万别，归根到底是因为历史时期社会存在和发展规律所决定的社会演变存在差异，不是哪个民族优越或者卑劣的问题。无论是被公认的优秀民族还是被人鄙视的民族，都一样被社会科学的客观规律囊括在内。决定他们命运的不是智力或者体力这样的“种族差异”，而是其经历的历史进程演变。在这种情况下，种族主义自然就失去了其土壤。衷心希望有朝一日世界各地的人民在用好奇的眼光打量彼此之时，能够意识到他们之间的差异不是因为种族或者“文化基因”这样荒谬的说法，而是因为他们经历的，现在所处的社会形态不同。从历史发展的意义来说，欧美国家和日本的确是全人类的榜样。